

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ J 9 4 3
♥ Q 10 7 5
♦ J 9 3 2
♣ A

♠ Q 6 5

♥ 8 6 4

♦ K Q 8 6

♣ 10 8 7



♠ 10 7

♥ J 9 2

♦ 10 7 5

♣ J 6 5 3 2

♠ A K 8 2

♥ A K 3

♦ A 4

♣ K Q 9 4

You dealt this hand.

With 23 points you naturally open 2♣. Partner responds 2♦.

You have 23 points and no 5-card suit. Since your hand is balanced you bid 2NT. Partner raises to 3NT and you pass.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
			2♣
Pass	2♦	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by South			
Lead: ♦ 2			

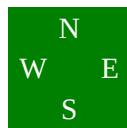
Board 2

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ J 9 6
 ♥ J 8 7 2
 ♦ Q J 5
 ♣ K 5 2

♠ 10 8 7 2
 ♥ Q 5 3
 ♦ 8 6 4
 ♣ 9 7 4



♠ A 4 3
 ♥ 10 9 4
 ♦ 10 7 3
 ♣ Q J 6 3

♠ K Q 5
 ♥ A K 6
 ♦ A K 9 2
 ♣ A 10 8

With only 2 points you make a Negative 2♦ response to partner's 2♣ opener. He now bids 2NT. What is your bid?

This isn't as clear-cut a decision as you might think at first. Partner is showing 22-24 points, and even though you only have 2 points it is possible that the partnership total could be 26. The thing that should convince you to pass is that a 24-2 point split doesn't play nearly as well as say a 13-13 split would. Lack of transportation would likely kill any chance of 3NT (or 4♠). So you pass.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
			2♣
Pass	2♦	Pass	2NT
All Pass			
2NT by South			
Lead: ♠9			

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ J 7
♥ J 10 5
♦ J 7 5
♣ J 6 5 3 2

♠ Q 6 5

♥ 8 6 4

♦ Q 9 8 6

♣ 10 8 7



♠ 10 9 4 3

♥ Q 9 7 2

♦ 10 4 3 2

♣ A

♠ A K 8 2

♥ A K 3

♦ A K

♣ K Q 9 4

You dealt this hand.

With 26 points you naturally open 2♣. Partner responds 2♦.

You have 26 points and no 5-card suit. Since your hand is balanced you bid 3NT. Everybody passes.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
			2♣
Pass	2♦	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
3NT by South			
Lead: ♣3			

Board 4

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ 9 7 6 4 3

♥ 9 7 2

♦ J 3

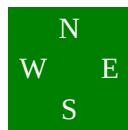
♣ 7 3 2

♠ J 10 8 2

♥ Q 5 3

♦ 8 6 4

♣ J 9 4



♠ A

♥ J 10 8 4

♦ Q 10 7 5

♣ K Q 6 5

♠ K Q 5

♥ A K 6

♦ A K 9 2

♣ A 10 8

With only 4 points you make a Negative 2♦ response to partner's 2♣ opener. He now bids 2NT. What is your bid?

True, 4 points isn't much. But added to partner's 22-24 it becomes enough for a game. Your problem isn't whether to bid to the game or not, (you definitely will), but whether you should use Stayman to find out if there is a 4-4 ♠ fit. You decide not to do this because your 4-3-3-3 distribution removes the possibility of you getting any ruffs. So you bid 3NT.

West

North

East

South

Pass

2♦

Pass

2♣

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

Lead: ♥7

Board 5

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 6 5 4
 ♥ 5
 ♦ K 10 9 6
 ♣ A 8 6 5

♠ K 8 7 3

♥ 9 2

♦ J 8 7 4 2

♣ 10 3



♠ A J 10 9 2

♥ 10 7

♦ Q 3

♣ K 9 7 2

♠ —

♥ A K Q J 8 6 4 3

♦ A 5

♣ Q J 4

West	North	East	South
			2♣
Pass	2♦	Pass	2♥
Pass	2NT	Pass	4♥
All Pass			
4♥ by South			
Lead: ♦10			

You dealt this hand.

You only have 20 points, but you have 9 playing tricks. You have two choices, open 4♥ or open 2♣. Usually 4♥ would show a slightly weaker hand than this, so you bid 2♣. Partner responds 2♦.

Of course you bid your 8-card suit. But no jumping, just bid 2♥. Partner now says 2NT.

Partner has between 3 and 7 points. Somewhere in those points might be the one trick you need, but you don't have any scientific way of finding out. So just bid 4♥ and hope. (There it is, the ♣10.)